

Tentative Rulings for July 16, 2026, Probate Calendar

Judge James T. Chou
Department C

**APPEARANCES MAY BE MADE
IN PERSON
OR ON ZOOM.**

To Join a Zoom Meeting, please follow this link: www.marin.courts.ca.gov

1. Click on the “Virtual Courtrooms” icon and then on “Zoom Civil / Family / Probate Court Calendar Appearance Information”
2. Scroll down to Department C – Probate for the connection information.

Any interested party who wishes to appear for oral argument on the tentative ruling **must do the following no later than 4:00 PM** one Court day prior to the scheduled hearing date (MCR 6.2.D):

1. Notify all other parties entitled to notice of the underlying petition, including the attorneys for represented parties; and
2. Advise the clerk’s office by leaving a message at **(415) 444-7046, option 5.**

There is no need to inform the Court of your intent to appear if the tentative ruling requires an appearance.

PLEASE NOTE: Probate cases that are designated as confidential by California law will not be posted online. For tentative rulings in those matters, please contact the judicial secretary at **(415) 444-7260**. Confidential cases include applications for Special Immigrant Juvenile Status.

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Judge James T. Chou
Department C
9:00 Calendar

CV0010299 RENEE PRECIADO VS. EDWARD KOPLOZWITZ

Petition for Approval of Compromise of Claim or Action or Disposition of Proceeds of Judgment for Minor or Person with a Disability, filed by Elisha Preciado on 6/1/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**.

PR0000828 IN THE MATTER OF MAURA BURKE MOREY

First and Final Account and Report of Executor and Petition for Its Settlement for Final Distribution; for Confirmation of Costs Paid Through Attorney Trust Account; for Allowance of Compensation to Estate Tax Return Preparer; for Allowance of Statutory Compensation to Attorneys for Ordinary Services and for Extraordinary Services; and Remaining Costs, filed by Edward B. Morey on 6/11/26.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PR0001100 IN THE MATTER OF JAMES BRYAN BYRNES

1. Final Account and Report of Executor and Petition for Settlement and Approval; for (1) Allowance of Statutory Attorney's Compensation and Executor's Compensation, and (2) Final Distribution, filed by Gianna Rehge on 6/30/26.
2. Petition to Compel Accounting of the Estate of James B. Byrnes, filed by Kevin Tracy on 5/6/26.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.** The Petition to Compel Accounting of the Estate is **granted**; the Court notes that Executor Gianna Rehage has now filed a new petition for final distribution that includes a final account.

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PR0001113 IN THE MATTER OF DOUGLAS REID REIMER

First and Final Account and Report of Administrator and Petition for: (1) Settlement Thereof; (2) Statutory Administrator's Commissions and Attorneys' Fees; (3) Reimbursement of Costs; (4) Authority to Hold Reserve; and (5) Final Distribution, filed by Kenneth Schwartz on 6/5/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**. Petitioner is **ordered to submit** a proposed Order to the Court, no later than five court days from the date of this hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 6.2(C), Submission of Proposed Orders.)

PR0001322 IN THE MATTER OF NOBUKO NIN

First and Final Report and Petition for Final Distribution on Waiver of Account, Allowance of Statutory Compensation to Attorney, Waiver of Compensation to Administrator, filed by Hayato Nin on 6/4/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**.

PR0001434 IN THE MATTER OF THE AMENDED AND RESTATED NANCY B. DREW TRUST

1. First Amended Petition to Invalidate the 2024 Restatement of the Nancy B. Drew Trust and 2024 Will Because of Undue Influence; for Accounting; for Recovery of Trust Property Under Cal. Prob. Code Section 850; for Damages and Attorneys' Fees for Financial Elder Abuse, Physical Elder Abuse, Negligence, Wilful Misconduct, Undue Influence, Breach of Fiduciary Duties, Unjust Enrichment, and Fraud and Deceit, filed by Robert Drew and Cindi L. Baker on 1/12/26.
2. Status Conference – Motion to consolidate; discovery; civil matter; set further proceedings

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PR0001547 IN THE MATTER OF MARY JOHN MICHAEL PITMAN

1. Petition to Revoke Probate of Purported Lost Will of John Michael Pitman, filed by Elizabeth Brooks on 4/17/26.
2. Petition for Order Granting Authorized Access to Review a Confidential File, filed by William Bruce Pitman on 4/29/26.

Ruling. After consideration of the filed pleadings, the **Court finds** that William Bruce Pitman failed to provide proper notice to Elizabeth Brooks of his Petition to Administer the Estate of John Michael Pitman filed on November 17, 2025. Consequently, The Petition to Revoke Probate of Purported Lost Will of John Michael Pitman filed by Elizabeth Brooks on April 17, 2026, is **granted in part and denied in part as follows**:

The Court's December 18, 2025, Order Appointing Administrator with Will Annexed Authorizing Independent Administration of Estate with Full Authority is **vacated**. The letters of administration

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issued in favor of William Bruce Pitman on January 2, 2026, are **vacated**. All other requests in said petition are **denied**. Counsel for Elizabeth Brooks is **ordered to submit** a proposed order consistent with this ruling by no later than July 23, 2026.

With respect to the Petition for Order Granting Authorized Access to Review a Confidential File, there is no signed Proof of Service in the file and it does not appear that parties to the action in PRO41567 received notice of this Petition, or in the alternative that a declaration of due diligence was filed explaining why such individual should not be served. This Petition is **denied**.

PR0001574 IN THE MATTER OF GOLDSTEIN FAMILY 2012 TRUST

1. Petition to Instruct, Surcharge, Remove, and Suspend Trustee Mark Goldstein; to Compel Trustee to Account; to Confirm Powers of Co-Trustee; and to Appoint Successor Trustee, filed by Jack Goldstein and Athena Goldstein on 12/2/25.
2. Status Conference – Accounting; meet and confer efforts; finances; set evidentiary hearing

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PR0001727 IN THE MATTER OF MARTHA LAVEARN GRANT

Petition for Letters of Administration, filed by Monique Johnson on 3/23/26.

Ruling. This Petition is now **dismissed** based on Petitioner’s failure to comply with this Court’s April 16, 2026, order.

PR0001759 IN THE MATTER OF LISE SONNEN TRUST – 2000 FIRST AMENDED – RESTATEMENT

1. Petition for Order Modifying Trust Due to Changed Circumstances Unanticipated by the Settlor, filed by Christopher Sheron on 4/10/26.
2. Receipt of report from Guardian ad Litem.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PR0001787 IN THE MATTER OF OSCAR CARLSON

Petition for Letters of Administration, filed by Linnea Carlson on 4/29/26.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

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PR0001805 IN THE MATTER OF JOAN VON BRIESEN TRUST

Petition for Order Confirming Trust Assets, filed by Peter Edmond Fimrite on 5/11/26.

Ruling. This petition is **denied** for failure to comply with California Rules of Court, Rule 2.108. Counsel is **directed to review** California Rules of Court, Rules 2.100-2.119 with respect to any filings made in this Court.

PR0001817 IN THE MATTER OF DENICE A. STOOPS

Petition for Probate of Will and for Letters Testamentary, filed by Lisa Dammann on 5/19/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**. Petitioner is **ordered to comply** with the following future dates:

1. Final Inventory and Appraisal.
 - a. A status hearing for the filing of the Final Inventory and Appraisal shall be set on December 3, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (Prob. Code, § 8800.)
 - b. An appearance will be required on that date if the Final Inventory and Appraisal is not filed at least five court days prior to hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 6.2(B), Filing, Hearing, and Continuance Procedures.)
2. Status on Closing Estate.
 - a. Either (1) a Petition for Final Distribution; or (2) a Report on Status of Administration shall be filed by July 22, 2027, as required by Probate Code sections 12200 and 12201.
 - b. A status hearing re filing the Petition or Report shall be set on August 12, 2027, at 10:00 a.m.
 - i. If neither document has been timely filed, an appearance will be required.
 - ii. If the Petition or Report is timely filed, the hearing will be set on August 12, 2027, at 9:00 a.m.

PR0001823 IN THE MATTER OF SAMUEL BLACKWOOD COGSWELL

Petition for Letters of Administration

Ruling. This matter is **continued to August 6, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.** **Petitioner is ordered to:**

1. **File** a Supplement to Petition, signed and verified by Petitioner, that:
 - a. Provides the information required by Item 5a re issue of predeceased child.
 - b. Provides the information required by Item 7 re predeceased spouse.
 - c. Provides the name, relationship, age, and address for any party named in response to the above.
2. **Mail** notice of the Petition for Probate to all interested parties using the mandatory Judicial Council Form "Notice of Petition to Administer Estate." (Judicial Council Forms, form DE-121.)

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3. **File** a copy of the DE-121 that was mailed, with the Proof of Service completed on page 2 showing that all interested parties received at least fifteen days' notice of the Petition for Probate. (Prob. Code, § 8110.)
4. All documents **must be filed** at least five court days prior to hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 6.2(b), Filing, Hearing, and Continuance Procedures.)

PR0001827 IN THE MATTER OF GAIL ANN TAYLOR

Spousal Property Petition, filed by Jerry Taylor on 7/9/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**.

PR0001848 IN THE MATTER OF KATHLEEN J. PANFIGLIO

Petition for Letters of Administration, filed by Annerose Fong on 6/12/26.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

If this Petition is granted at the hearing, Petitioner is **ordered to comply** with the following future dates:

1. Final Inventory and Appraisal.
 - a. A status hearing for the filing of the Final Inventory and Appraisal shall be set on December 3, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (Prob. Code, § 8800.)
 - b. An appearance will be required on that date if the Final Inventory and Appraisal is not filed at least five court days prior to hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 6.2(B), Filing, Hearing, and Continuance Procedures.)
2. Status on Closing Estate.
 - a. Either (1) a Petition for Final Distribution; or (2) a Report on Status of Administration shall be filed by July 22, 2027, as required by Probate Code sections 12200 and 12201.
 - b. A status hearing re filing the Petition or Report shall be set on August 12, 2027, at 10:00 a.m.
 - i. If neither document has been timely filed, an appearance will be required.
 - ii. If the Petition or Report is timely filed, the hearing will be set on August 12, 2027, at 9:00 a.m.

PR0001849 IN THE MATTER OF CAREN GORENBERG

Petition for Probate of Will and for Letters Testamentary, filed by Michael Gorenberg on 6/15/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**. Petitioner is **ordered to comply** with the following future dates:

1. Final Inventory and Appraisal.

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- a. A status hearing for the filing of the Final Inventory and Appraisal shall be set on December 3, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (Prob. Code, § 8800.)
 - b. An appearance will be required on that date if the Final Inventory and Appraisal is not filed at least five court days prior to hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 6.2(B), Filing, Hearing, and Continuance Procedures.)
2. Status on Closing Estate.
 - a. Either (1) a Petition for Final Distribution; or (2) a Report on Status of Administration shall be filed by July 22, 2027, as required by Probate Code sections 12200 and 12201.
 - b. A status hearing re filing the Petition or Report shall be set on August 12, 2027, at 10:00 a.m.
 - i. If neither document has been timely filed, an appearance will be required.
 - ii. If the Petition or Report is timely filed, the hearing will be set on August 12, 2027, at 9:00 a.m.

PR0001854 IN THE MATTER OF JOHN MARK PEIRSOL

Petition for Probate of Lost Will and for Letters of Administration with Will Annexed, filed by Catherine Peirsol-Schipper on 6/17/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, this Petition will be **granted without hearing**. Petitioner is **ordered to comply** with the following future dates:

1. Final Inventory and Appraisal.
 - a. A status hearing for the filing of the Final Inventory and Appraisal shall be set on December 3, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (Prob. Code, § 8800.)
 - b. An appearance will be required on that date if the Final Inventory and Appraisal is not filed at least five court days prior to hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 6.2(B), Filing, Hearing, and Continuance Procedures.)
2. Status on Closing Estate.
 - a. Either (1) a Petition for Final Distribution; or (2) a Report on Status of Administration shall be filed by July 22, 2027, as required by Probate Code sections 12200 and 12201.
 - b. A status hearing re filing the Petition or Report shall be set on August 12, 2027, at 10:00 a.m.
 - i. If neither document has been timely filed, an appearance will be required.
 - ii. If the Petition or Report is timely filed, the hearing will be set on August 12, 2027, at 9:00 a.m.

PR0001855 IN THE MATTER OF TERI JEAN TAKETA-GRAHAM

Petition for Probate of Will and for Letters Testamentary, filed by Tori Creighton-Lemos and Lisa Ann Lucchesi on 6/17/26.

Ruling. This matter is **continued to August 6, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.** Petitioner is **ordered to:**

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1. **Lodge** the original Will with the Court no later than five Court days prior to hearing. (Prob. Code, § 8200.)

PRO1702992 IN RE THE DONALD PERRY RESIDUAL TRUST, TRUST OF

Verified Petition for Approval of the Fourth and Final Account and Final Distribution of the Donald Perry Residual Trust, filed by Joan E. Perry on 3/2/26.

Ruling. This matter is **continued to August 27, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.** The Supplement to the Verified Petition filed 6/23/26 alleges facts and requests relief materially different from the original Petition and therefore is an Amendment to Petition. (California Rules of Court, Rule 7.3(4)). All interested parties must receive at least 30 days' notice of the 6/23/26 Supplement. (California Rules of Court, Rule 7.53(a).

Petitioner is ordered to:

1. **Mail** notice of the to all interested parties using the mandatory Judicial Council Form "Notice of Hearing – Decedent's Estate or Trust" (DE-120).
2. **File** a copy of the DE-120 that was mailed, with the Proof of Service completed on page two showing that all interested parties received at least thirty days' notice of the Supplement to the Verified Petition. (Prob. Code. §17203.) The Proof of Service must be filed at least five court days prior to hearing. (Super. Ct. Marin County, Local Rules, rule 7.53), Filing, Hearing, and Continuance Procedures.)

PRO2102432 DUCK YO QUOSS, ESTATE OF

Petition for Approval of Report of Status of Administration and Petition Requesting Additional Time for Estate Administration, filed by Caron Schmierer on 6/29/26.

Ruling. Absent objections, the Report of Status of Administration is **accepted and approved**. Personal Representative is ordered to comply with the following future dates:

1. Status on Closing Estate.
 - a. Either: (1) a Petition for Final Distribution; or (2) a Report of Status of Administration shall be filed by October 15, 2026, as required by Probate Code sections 12200-12201.
 - b. A status hearing re filing the Petition or Report shall be set on **November 5, 2026**, at 10:00 a.m.
 - i. If neither document has been timely filed, an appearance will be required.
 - ii. If the Petition or Report is timely filed, the hearing will be set on **November 5, 2026**, at 9:00 a.m.

PRO2200267 IN THE MATTER OF THE ANDERSON FAMILY TRUST

First Account and Report of Trustee; Petition to Settle Account; and for Confirmation of Trustee Fees and Attorney Fees, filed by Elizabeth Soloway on 5/15/26.

Ruling. This matter is **continued to July 30, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. for further review.**

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PRO2202479 SEAN HALEY THACKREY, ESTATE OF

1. Status Conference - Status Report of Administration or Petition for Final Distribution
2. Status Conference - Filing of Final Inventory and Appraisal and status of sale of Bolinas property and creditors claim
3. Status Conference – Sale of Bolinas Property

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PRO2203072 ROBERT E. GREELEY, ESTATE OF

(1) Final Account and Report of Administration; (2) Petition for Allowance of Statutory and Extraordinary Executor Commissions; (3) Petition for Allowance of Statutory and Extraordinary Attorneys' Fees; and (4) Petition for Final Distribution, filed by Sean Moynihan on 6/10/26.

Ruling. This matter is **continued to July 30, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. for further review.**

Judge James T. Chou
Department C
10:00 Calendar

PR000552 IN THE MATTER OF ISABEL PONCE FLORES

Status Conference - Status Report of Administration or Petition for Final Distribution; status regarding Santa Clara litigation

Ruling. Personal representatives and counsel are **ordered to appear**.

PR000724 IN THE MATTER OF ALI NAZARI

Status Conference – Receipt of Order and funds for deposit in blocked account

Ruling. This matter is ordered **off calendar**; the Receipt and Acknowledgement has been filed.

PR000753 IN THE MATTER OF NELSON GEORGE GORDY

Status Conference - Final Distribution or Report on Status of Administration

Ruling. Personal representative is **ordered to appear**.

PR0001256 IN THE MATTER OF DANIEL JUDAH GARE

1. Order - Show Cause – Failure to appear; failure to file Final Inventory and Appraisal
2. Status Conference - Filing of Final Inventory and Appraisal

Ruling. Personal representative and counsel are **ordered to appear**.

PR0001333 IN THE MATTER OF EVA CAPRILE

1. Order - Show Cause – Failure to appear; failure to file Final Inventory and Appraisal
2. Status Conference - Filing of Final Inventory and Appraisal

Ruling. Personal representative and counsel are **ordered to appear**.

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PR0001449 IN THE MATTER OF HELEN CHARLOTTE GILDRED

Status Conference - Final Inventory and Appraisal

Ruling. Personal representative and counsel are **ordered to appear** to discuss Item 5 of the Final Inventory and Appraisal.

PR0001497 IN THE MATTER OF EVE PREMINGER

Status Conference - Final Inventory and Appraisal

Ruling. This matter is ordered **off calendar**; the Final Inventory and Appraisal has been filed.

PR0001561 IN THE MATTER OF KIP TERRANCE BUNYEA, SR.

Status Conference - Final Inventory and Appraisal

Ruling. This matter is ordered **off calendar**; the Final Inventory and Appraisal has been filed.

PRO1800208 IN RE THE CATHERINE EMILY PHILLIPS SPECIAL NEEDS TRUST, TRUST OF

Status Conference – Fourth Report

Ruling. This matter is **continued to October 15, 2026 at 10:00 a.m.**

PRO1802115 ROSEMARY THERESA BOCK, ESTATE OF

Status Conference - Final Distribution or Report on Status of Administration

Ruling. Personal representative and counsel are **ordered to appear**.

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Judge James T. Chou
Department C
1:30 Calendar

PR0001023 IN THE MATTER OF WALTER HALLANAN

Amended Petition for Substituted Judgment to Clarify Conservatee's IRA Beneficiary and Place Conservatee's Berkeley Real Property and Tangible Personal Property Into Conservatee's Trust, filed by John Bacon, Jr. on 5/13/26.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PR0001331 IN THE MATTER OF JULIE YOUNG

Order – Show Cause – Failure to appear; failure to comply with citation

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PR0001468 IN RE THE DAX PHILIPS REVOCABLE LIVING TRUST

1. Status Conference – Compliance with court's orders and continuing stay
2. Order - Show Cause – Sanctions/Contempt

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PRO1704652 IN THE MATTER OF DAXTON WEST PHILIPS

1. Second Report and Account of Guardian and Petition for Order (1) Settling and Approving Account; (2) Confirming All Acts of Guardian; (3) Awarding Guardians and Attorneys Fees and Reimbursement of Costs Advanced; and (4) Decreasing Bond, filed by Daniel J. Cunningham on 4/1/26.
2. Petition for Order Fixing Amount of Surcharge, filed by Daniel J. Cunningham on 4/6/26.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

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PR0001639 IN THE MATTER OF BARBARA LEE MAHONEY

1. First and Final Account, Petition for Termination of Temporary Conservatorship and for Discharge of Conservator, and Waiver of Fees, filed by Danielle Lacampagne on 4/28/26.
2. Order - Show Cause - Dismiss Petition to Appoint Conservator in light of Conservatee's death

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**

PRO1602863 OLIVIA ROSE GOMEZ, GUARDIANSHIP OF THE PERSON

Petition for Termination of Conservatorship, filed by Olicia Gomez on 9/22/25.

Ruling. **The parties are ordered to appear.**
